

VCSU AI Institute for Teaching and Learning

Module Challenges by Role — All 31 Modules (Revised)

F: Foundations of AI Literacy

F1.1: Understanding AI: Concepts, Capabilities & Limitations

Teacher

Students and educators are using generative AI more often, while understanding of how models are trained, why outputs can be inaccurate, and when human verification is required varies widely across schools. Educators need a shared foundation so they can explain AI capabilities and limitations accurately and help students engage with these tools critically.

School/District Leader

School and district leaders are expected to guide staff and community conversations about AI, yet many lack a shared vocabulary for explaining what AI tools can and cannot do. Without a foundational understanding of how these systems work, leaders struggle to make informed decisions about adoption, policy, and professional development.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers are seeing students with disabilities use AI tools in and out of school, but they lack a clear understanding of how these systems generate outputs and where they fall short. Without this foundation, it is difficult to guide students in using AI responsibly, to evaluate whether AI-generated content meets their specific learning needs, or to make informed decisions about using AI in their own practice.

Support Staff

Support staff members are increasingly encountering AI tools in their daily workflows and in student interactions, yet they have not had the opportunity to build a foundational understanding of how these systems work. Without this knowledge, it is difficult to use AI tools confidently in their own role or to guide students and families toward responsible and effective use.

Instructional Coach

Teachers are increasingly turning to instructional coaches with questions about AI tools, and they are expected to help them navigate these decisions. But they cannot guide others effectively if they do not have a clear, accurate understanding of how these systems

generate outputs, where they fail, and what that means for classroom use. They need a strong foundation before they can coach with confidence.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty are encountering AI-generated work in student submissions with increasing frequency, yet many have not developed a working understanding of how these tools produce outputs or where they fail. Without this foundation, it is difficult to design meaningful learning experiences or engage students in honest conversations about AI's role in academic work.

F1.2: Ethics, Bias & Data Privacy in Education

Teacher

When educators use AI tools to prepare instructional materials, they may encounter outputs that reflect bias — missing or misrepresenting the perspectives of historically underrepresented communities. Educators need practical frameworks for evaluating AI-generated content for bias, protecting student information, verifying claims with reliable sources, and determining whether a tool is appropriate for their context and community.

School/District Leader

Leaders are responsible for ensuring that AI tools used across their schools and districts are implemented in ways that protect student privacy, avoid bias, and align with ethical standards. Without a structured approach to evaluating these risks, decisions about AI adoption are often made without adequate scrutiny of the tools' potential harms.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers work with students whose data is protected by some of the strongest privacy laws in education. When they use AI tools to generate materials, draft IEP communications, or support student learning, they must be especially attentive to bias and privacy risks. AI tools trained on general data may not reflect the needs of students with disabilities, and sharing student information with AI platforms raises important legal and ethical questions under FERPA and IDEA.

Support Staff

Support staff members interact with sensitive student information every day — in counseling notes, referral forms, attendance records, and family communications. They need to understand the ethical boundaries of AI use in these sensitive contexts, including questions about data privacy, bias in AI recommendations, and transparency with families. Getting this wrong can harm students and erode the trust that makes their roles effective.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches recommend and model AI tools for teachers, which means they carry a responsibility to evaluate those tools for ethical risks before bringing them into classrooms. Without a structured review process, they may introduce tools that introduce

bias, compromise student privacy, or undermine the trust of the teachers and families they serve.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty who use AI tools to support course design, feedback, or research face real ethical questions about bias in AI outputs, student data privacy, and the transparency of AI-assisted work. Without a framework for evaluating these risks, faculty may inadvertently model uncritical AI use for their students.

F1.3: Establishing Responsible AI Norms & Academic Integrity

Teacher

Schools need clear, age-appropriate expectations for AI use that work across assignments, courses, and communities. Policies must balance responsible access, academic integrity, and student agency while remaining practical for teachers to implement and families to understand.

School/District Leader

Leaders are responsible for establishing clear, consistent expectations for AI use across their schools and districts, yet many have not yet developed policies that address academic integrity, equitable access, or the responsible use of AI-generated content. Without shared norms, staff and students are left to navigate these questions on their own.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers must navigate AI norms in ways that account for the unique needs of their students. Some of their students use AI tools as assistive technology under their IEPs, while others are expected to demonstrate learning without AI support. Establishing clear, equitable norms for AI use requires balancing academic integrity with the legal obligation to provide individualized accommodations — and communicating these distinctions clearly to students, families, and colleagues.

Support Staff

Students and families often ask support staff members directly about what is and is not allowed when it comes to AI use at school. They want to give accurate, consistent answers, but they are not always sure what the school's expectations are or how to explain them in ways that make sense to students who are already using these tools outside of school. They need clear, shared guidance they can communicate confidently.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches are hearing very different approaches to AI norms across classrooms in their school. Some teachers have strict no-AI policies; others are allowing broad use with no clear guidelines. They need practical tools for facilitating conversations about shared norms and helping teachers develop expectations that are both enforceable and educationally sound — without imposing a one-size-fits-all policy.

Higher Ed Faculty

Academic integrity policies at most institutions were written before generative AI became widely accessible, leaving faculty without clear guidance on how to address AI use in student work. Faculty need practical frameworks for establishing transparent expectations and designing learning experiences that remain meaningful in an AI-accessible environment.

T: AI for Teaching

T1.1: Standards-Aligned Lesson Design with AI

Teacher

Teachers designing standards-aligned units face the time-consuming work of unpacking standards, building coherent assessments, and creating accessible learning experiences for varied learners. AI can accelerate parts of this process, but all AI-generated content requires careful review for accuracy, standards alignment, and appropriateness for the specific students and community being served.

School/District Leader

Leaders are responsible for ensuring that AI-assisted instructional planning across their schools and districts produces lessons that are genuinely aligned to standards and responsive to student needs. Without clear expectations and shared frameworks, AI tools may be used in ways that prioritize efficiency over instructional quality.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers are responsible for designing instruction that is both aligned with grade-level standards and genuinely accessible to students with a wide range of disabilities. They want to use AI to accelerate the process of unpacking standards, building assessments, and creating modified materials — but they need to ensure that AI-generated content is appropriately adapted for their students and aligned with their IEP goals, not just the general curriculum.

Support Staff

Support staff members often implement instructional activities designed by classroom teachers, but they are not always involved in the planning process. They want to understand how AI is being used to design standards-aligned instruction so they can support these lessons more effectively and communicate more clearly with teachers about what students need during their support time.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches are supporting teachers in using AI to design more rigorous, standards-aligned units and lessons. They need practical coaching moves for helping teachers use AI as a planning partner — while ensuring that the resulting lessons reflect deep knowledge of their students, not just AI-generated templates that may not fit the specific context of their classrooms.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty who want to use AI to support course design and lesson planning face the challenge of ensuring that AI-generated materials maintain the intellectual rigor and disciplinary depth that define high-quality higher education. Using AI effectively for instructional design requires both technical skill and strong pedagogical judgment.

T4.1: Workload Analysis & High-Value Automation

Teacher

Educators carrying multiple course preparations, activities, committees, and student-support responsibilities often struggle to find time for the high-value work that most benefits students. Schools need practical ways to identify low-risk, repetitive tasks that AI tools can streamline while protecting student information, preserving professional judgment, and reinvesting saved time in direct student support.

School/District Leader

Leaders who want to use AI to reduce administrative burden and improve organizational efficiency must develop a clear-eyed view of which tasks are genuinely suitable for AI automation and which require sustained human judgment and relationship. Without this clarity, AI adoption in leadership contexts can create new inefficiencies or undermine the trust and transparency that effective leadership requires.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers face some of the heaviest documentation and administrative demands in education — IEP writing, progress monitoring, compliance reporting, and family communication — on top of their direct instructional responsibilities. They want to use AI to reduce this burden, but they need a clear framework for identifying which tasks are genuinely suitable for AI support and which require the individualized, relationship-based judgment that defines special education practice.

Support Staff

Support staff members manage a wide range of tasks across their day — from direct student support to administrative logistics, communication, and documentation. They want to use AI to work more efficiently, but they need practical strategies for identifying which parts of their roles are strong candidates for AI support and which require the human judgment, relationship, and contextual knowledge that make their work effective.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches spend significant time on scheduling, communication, resource curation, and documentation — tasks that take them away from the direct coaching work that has the greatest impact. They need a practical framework for identifying high-value automation opportunities in their own workflow so they can reclaim time for the relational, human-centered work of coaching that cannot be replicated by AI.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty who want to use AI to manage the administrative demands of academic work — including grading, feedback, course communications, and research documentation — need practical strategies for identifying which tasks are genuinely suitable for AI support and which require the kind of deep intellectual engagement that defines academic work. Using AI for workload management requires both technical skill and clear professional boundaries.

T3.1: SEL Frameworks & AI-Enhanced Instruction

Teacher

Schools strengthening social-emotional and behavioral supports face a tension: teachers have limited planning time and varied access to counselors, yet students' social-emotional needs are significant. Educators need developmentally appropriate strategies that promote belonging and self-management without asking AI to diagnose emotions or process sensitive student information.

School/District Leader

Leaders who want to build a school culture that supports student social-emotional development must help teachers integrate SEL frameworks into their daily instruction in ways that are authentic and sustainable. AI tools offer new possibilities for supporting SEL-aligned instruction, but leaders must ensure that these tools enhance rather than replace the genuine human relationships at the heart of effective SEL practice.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers support students whose social-emotional needs are often closely connected to their disabilities. They want to use AI to help design SEL instruction and support strategies that are genuinely accessible and appropriate for students with diverse needs — but they must ensure that AI-generated materials are reviewed carefully for appropriateness and that the relational, individualized quality of SEL support is preserved.

Support Staff

Support staff members are often on the front lines of social-emotional support for students. They want to use AI to help them find resources, draft communication, and support students more effectively, but they need to ensure that AI tools are used in ways that strengthen rather than replace the human relationships that are at the heart of effective SEL support.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches support teachers in integrating SEL frameworks into their instruction and building classroom environments where students feel safe, connected, and ready to learn. They need practical coaching strategies for helping teachers use AI to design more responsive SEL supports — while ensuring that the relational, human-centered quality of effective SEL instruction is not lost in the efficiency gains that AI can offer.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty who want to support the social-emotional development of their students must find ways to integrate SEL principles into their courses in ways that are appropriate for higher education contexts. AI tools can support the design of SEL-aligned learning experiences, but faculty need practical strategies for doing so in ways that maintain academic rigor.

T2.1: AI-Assisted Formative Assessment Design

Teacher

Teachers need frequent evidence of student understanding between formal assessment windows. AI can accelerate the drafting of formative assessments, but each item must align with the intended standard, elicit the targeted thinking, remain accessible to all learners, and be reviewed by an educator before use.

School/District Leader

Leaders who want to improve the quality and consistency of formative assessment practices across their schools and districts face the challenge of helping teachers design assessments that provide timely, actionable data without adding to their workload. AI tools offer new possibilities for supporting assessment design, but these tools must be used in ways that maintain instructional alignment and pedagogical quality.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers design formative assessments for students with disabilities that must be both aligned with grade-level standards and genuinely accessible to their students. AI can accelerate the drafting of assessment items, but they must ensure that each item is appropriate for students with diverse learning needs, aligned with IEP goals where relevant, and reviewed carefully for accessibility before use.

Support Staff

Support staff members sometimes work with students on academic skills and progress monitoring, but they do not always have the tools or training to design formal assessments. They want to understand how AI is being used to support formative assessment design so they can better support students during their time with them and communicate more effectively with teachers about what they are observing.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches support teachers in designing formative assessments that generate actionable evidence of student learning. They need practical coaching moves for helping teachers use AI to accelerate assessment drafting — while ensuring that the resulting items are aligned with learning targets, appropriate for the students in each classroom, and used in ways that actually inform instructional decisions.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty who want to use AI to support formative assessment in their courses need practical strategies for designing assessments that provide meaningful feedback to students and

useful data for instructional decision-making. AI can help generate assessment items and rubrics, but faculty need to ensure that these tools produce assessments that are rigorous, fair, and aligned to learning outcomes.

T2.2: Feedback Cycles & Reteaching Strategies

Teacher

Teachers want to provide timely, actionable feedback and reteach before learning gaps widen, but the volume of student work makes this difficult to sustain. Teams need efficient cycles that use actual student evidence — not AI assumptions — to identify misconceptions, generate response options, preserve student dignity, and determine whether reteaching improved mastery.

School/District Leader

Leaders who want to build a culture of effective feedback across their schools and districts must help teachers develop practices that provide students with timely, specific, and actionable feedback that genuinely supports learning. AI tools offer new possibilities for scaling feedback, but leaders must ensure that these tools are used in ways that maintain the quality and personalization that make feedback effective.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers provide feedback to students with disabilities that must be accessible, specific, and aligned with their IEP goals. They want to use AI to generate more timely and targeted feedback, but they must ensure that AI-generated feedback is appropriate for each student's communication needs, disability profile, and current level of performance — and that it is reviewed carefully before being shared with students or families.

Support Staff

Support staff members often provide informal feedback to students during their support interactions — correcting errors, encouraging effort, and helping students understand what they need to do differently. They want to use AI to help them give more specific and useful feedback in these moments, but they need practical strategies for doing this in ways that are appropriate to their roles and that reinforce rather than contradict the feedback students are receiving from their teachers.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches support teachers in developing more effective feedback practices — including the use of AI to generate timely, specific feedback at scale. They need practical coaching frameworks for helping teachers design feedback cycles that use AI efficiently while preserving the relational, formative quality of feedback that actually changes student learning.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty who teach large courses face significant challenges in providing timely, meaningful feedback on student work. AI tools offer new possibilities for scaling feedback without sacrificing quality, but faculty need practical strategies for using these tools in ways that maintain the intellectual engagement and personalization that students need to grow.

T3.2: PBIS, Restorative Supports & Intervention Drafting

Teacher

Schools seeing increased disengagement and classroom disruption need practical ways to strengthen PBIS, restorative responses, and tiered behavioral supports. Any AI assistance in this work must avoid predictive labels, account for cultural and disability-related factors, and ensure that trained adults — not algorithms — make all behavioral decisions.

School/District Leader

Leaders who are responsible for implementing PBIS frameworks and restorative practices across their schools and districts must help staff use these approaches consistently and effectively. AI tools offer new possibilities for supporting intervention planning and documentation, but leaders must ensure that these tools are used in ways that maintain the relational and restorative principles at the heart of these frameworks.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers design behavioral interventions for students with disabilities that must be individualized, evidence-based, and aligned with the principles of positive behavioral support and least restrictive environment. They want to use AI to help draft behavior support plans and intervention strategies more efficiently, but they must ensure that AI-generated recommendations are reviewed carefully and adapted to the specific needs, history, and context of each student.

Support Staff

Support staff members are often the first adult a student encounters when they are experiencing a behavioral challenge — and their response in that moment matters enormously. They want to use AI to help them prepare for these situations and develop more effective de-escalation and restorative strategies, but they need to ensure that their use of AI in this work is appropriate to their roles and that they are not making decisions that belong to teachers, counselors, or administrators.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches support teachers in implementing PBIS and restorative practices in ways that are consistent, equitable, and effective. They need practical coaching frameworks for helping teachers use AI to draft behavior support plans and intervention strategies — while ensuring that these plans are grounded in deep knowledge of individual students and that the relational, restorative focus that defines effective behavioral support is preserved.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty who want to support students experiencing behavioral or emotional challenges in their courses can use AI tools to help design proactive support strategies and develop restorative approaches to addressing academic misconduct or classroom disruptions. Using AI in these contexts requires careful attention to student dignity and the importance of maintaining a human-centered approach.

T1.2: Differentiation & Instructional Sequencing

Teacher

Teachers in inclusive classrooms serve students with a wide range of readiness levels, language backgrounds, and learning needs. They need efficient ways to sequence instruction and create multiple access points to grade-level content without lowering expectations or placing confidential student information in an unapproved AI tool.

School/District Leader

Leaders who want to support differentiated instruction across their schools and districts must help teachers move beyond one-size-fits-all approaches to genuinely responsive instructional sequencing. AI tools offer new possibilities for generating differentiated materials and identifying student needs, but these tools must be implemented in ways that are equitable and pedagogically sound.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers differentiation is at the heart of their practice — but the volume of individualized materials they need to create for students with varying disabilities, language backgrounds, and readiness levels is significant. They want to use AI to generate differentiated materials more efficiently, but they need to ensure that AI-generated adaptations are genuinely accessible, aligned with IEP accommodations, and reviewed carefully before use with students.

Support Staff

Support staff members often work one-on-one or in small groups with students who need additional support to access grade-level content. They want to use AI to help them find or create more accessible versions of materials quickly — but they need to know how to evaluate whether AI-generated adaptations are actually meeting their students' needs and how to communicate their observations back to classroom teachers.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches are helping teachers use AI to create more differentiated learning experiences for the diverse students in their classrooms. They need practical coaching frameworks for helping teachers use AI to generate scaffolded materials and varied learning pathways — while ensuring that differentiation decisions are still driven by teacher knowledge of their students, not just AI-generated defaults.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty who teach diverse student populations face the challenge of designing instruction that meets students where they are while maintaining high academic standards. AI tools can support differentiation and instructional sequencing, but faculty need practical strategies for using these tools in ways that genuinely respond to individual student needs rather than simply generating more content.

T4.2: Sustainable Workflows, Boundaries & Digital Well-Being

Teacher

Educators report that after-hours messages, documentation, grading, and new initiatives make sustainable work increasingly difficult. Teams need shared boundaries and AI-supported routines that reduce workload without weakening responsiveness, professional relationships, or the quality of service students and families receive.

School/District Leader

Leaders who want to model sustainable AI use for their staff and communities must develop clear personal boundaries around AI integration and find ways to use these tools that enhance rather than erode their professional well-being. Without intentional attention to sustainability and digital well-being, AI adoption can create new forms of overwork and burnout.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers work in a profession that already demands significant emotional and cognitive labor — and the pressure to integrate AI tools adds another layer of complexity. They need to develop sustainable workflows that reduce administrative burden without creating new forms of overwork or dependency, and they need to build healthy boundaries around AI use that protect their professional judgment and their relationships with students and families.

Support Staff

Support staff members are often expected to be available and responsive across a wide range of tasks and interactions, and the boundaries of their roles can be difficult to maintain. They need practical strategies for using AI to work more sustainably — including how to set appropriate limits on AI use, how to protect the human relationships that make their work meaningful, and how to model healthy digital habits for the students they support.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches are in a unique position: they not only need to develop their own sustainable AI practices, but they also need to help teachers develop theirs. They need practical frameworks for building healthy boundaries around AI use in their own coaching work — and for facilitating conversations with teachers about sustainable AI integration that are grounded in evidence and responsive to the real pressures teachers face.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty who integrate AI tools into their professional practice must develop sustainable workflows that enhance their work without creating new forms of dependency or overwork. Building healthy boundaries around AI use — and modeling these boundaries for students — is an important component of responsible AI integration in higher education.

T2.3: AI in Collaborative Teams

Teacher

Collaborative teams must analyze formative evidence from large numbers of students quickly enough to respond before the next instructional unit. Teams need AI-assisted protocols that accelerate data analysis while protecting student data, maintaining alignment to grade-level standards, and preserving the collective professional judgment that makes collaborative teams effective.

School/District Leader

Leaders who want to make collaborative team time more productive and focused on student learning must help teams use data and structured protocols to drive their work. AI tools offer new possibilities for supporting collaborative analysis and planning, but leaders must ensure that these tools enhance rather than replace the genuine professional dialogue that makes collaborative teams effective.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers participate in multiple collaborative teams — IEP teams, grade-level teams, multi-tiered support teams, and more. They want to use AI to help prepare for these meetings, analyze student data, and document outcomes more efficiently. But they must ensure that any AI tools used in collaborative settings are used in ways that protect student privacy and that the collaborative process itself remains centered on the individualized needs of each student.

Support Staff

Support staff members participate in case conferences, student support meetings, and team check-ins where their observations and relationships with students are valuable contributions. They want to use AI to help them prepare for these meetings and document their observations more effectively, but they need to understand how to contribute their unique perspective in ways that complement rather than duplicate the work of teachers and specialists.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches facilitate collaborative team meetings and support teachers in using data to drive instructional decisions. They need practical coaching frameworks for helping teams use AI to accelerate data analysis and meeting preparation — while ensuring that the collaborative process remains focused on student learning and that human judgment drives all instructional decisions.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty who participate in departmental or program-level collaborative work can use AI tools to help prepare for meetings, analyze shared data, and develop collaborative action plans. Using AI effectively in collaborative contexts requires clear agreements about how AI-generated content will be used and how human judgment will remain central to decision-making.

T1.3: Professional Communication & Workflow Efficiency

Teacher

Educators managing family communication, documentation, reporting, and instructional preparation across multiple responsibilities need AI-supported workflows that reduce repetitive work, preserve professional voice and local context, and protect student information — without creating new dependencies or technical burdens.

School/District Leader

Leaders face significant demands on their time and attention, and many are exploring how AI tools can help streamline professional communications, documentation, and administrative workflows. Using AI effectively for these purposes requires clear guidelines about appropriate use, data privacy, and the importance of maintaining a genuine human voice in communications.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers face some of the most demanding documentation requirements in education — IEP development, progress monitoring, compliance reporting, and family communication — all while managing a caseload of students with complex needs. They want to use AI to reduce this administrative burden, but they must ensure that AI-generated communications and documents are accurate, legally compliant, and appropriately individualized for each student and family.

Support Staff

Support staff members handle a wide range of communications and documentation tasks — from answering family inquiries to completing referral forms and logging student interactions. They want to use AI to manage these tasks more efficiently, but they need to ensure that AI-generated content maintains the warm, professional tone that families and students expect from support staff, and that sensitive information is handled appropriately.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches manage significant communication and documentation demands — coaching logs, professional development planning, teacher feedback, and administrative reporting. They want to use AI to handle these tasks more efficiently so they can spend more time on the direct coaching work that has the greatest impact. But they also need to ensure that their communications remain genuinely personal and that their coaching relationships are not undermined by over-reliance on AI-generated text.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty who want to use AI to manage the administrative demands of academic work — including email, feedback, documentation, and course communications — need practical strategies for doing so in ways that maintain professional standards and protect student privacy. AI can reduce workload, but it requires careful oversight to ensure quality and appropriateness.

T3.3: Behavioral Monitoring, Ethical Safeguards & Human Oversight

Teacher

Districts evaluating AI-enabled monitoring systems to support student safety face significant concerns from educators, families, and students about privacy, false positives, disability and cultural bias, and unclear escalation rules. Any decision to adopt such a system must include human review at every stage, data minimization, transparency with the community, and clear appeal procedures.

School/District Leader

Leaders who are responsible for behavioral monitoring systems across their schools and districts must ensure that these systems are used ethically, with appropriate human oversight and clear safeguards against bias and overreach. AI tools that support behavioral monitoring offer significant potential benefits, but also raise important questions about privacy, equity, and the appropriate role of technology in student support.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers use behavioral monitoring tools to track student progress toward IEP goals, and they must ensure that these systems are used in ways that are ethical, individualized, and aligned with the principles of least restrictive environment and positive behavioral support. AI tools can support more consistent monitoring, but must be used with careful attention to student privacy, the importance of maintaining a strengths-based approach, and the legal requirements of IDEA.

Support Staff

Support staff members may be involved in collecting behavioral data, implementing monitoring protocols, or supporting students who are subject to behavioral tracking systems. They need to understand the ethical boundaries of their roles in these systems — including how to protect student dignity and privacy, how to raise concerns when monitoring feels punitive or inequitable, and how to ensure that behavioral data is used to support rather than label students.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches support teachers in using behavioral monitoring tools in ways that are ethical, effective, and genuinely focused on student growth. They need practical coaching frameworks for helping teachers understand both the potential benefits and the significant ethical risks of AI-enabled monitoring systems — and for ensuring that human

judgment remains central to all intervention decisions, especially for students from historically marginalized groups.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty who use AI tools to monitor student engagement or flag students at risk of academic difficulty must navigate important ethical questions about privacy, consent, and the appropriate use of data in educational contexts. Using AI for behavioral monitoring in higher education requires clear policies, transparent communication with students, and robust human oversight.

T4.3: Human-Centered Implementation & Continuous Improvement

Teacher

Schools moving from scattered AI experiments to a disciplined, human-centered improvement process need a structured approach to piloting new tools. This means small pilots with clear safeguards, evidence of time and quality impact, genuine stakeholder feedback, and explicit stop-or-scale decision rules — so AI reduces burden rather than becoming another initiative to manage.

School/District Leader

Leaders who are responsible for guiding AI implementation across their schools and districts must develop approaches that center human relationships, professional judgment, and continuous improvement. Sustainable AI integration requires ongoing reflection, clear feedback mechanisms, and a commitment to adjusting implementation based on what is actually working for students and staff.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers integrate AI tools into a practice that is already subject to significant legal and professional accountability. They need to develop habits of reflection and continuous improvement that ensure AI tools are genuinely serving the needs of their students — including regular review of AI implementation, feedback from students and families, and adjustment based on evidence of impact on IEP goals and student outcomes.

Support Staff

Support staff members want to ensure that the AI tools they use in their work with students are actually making a difference — but they may not have formal structures for reflecting on their practice or gathering evidence of impact. They need practical, role-appropriate strategies for evaluating their AI use, adjusting their approaches based on what they observe, and contributing their insights to the broader school improvement process.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches play a central role in helping their school move from scattered AI experiments to a disciplined, evidence-based improvement process. They need practical frameworks for supporting teachers in piloting AI tools with clear safeguards, collecting

meaningful evidence of impact, and making informed decisions about whether to stop, revise, or scale their AI practices — all while keeping the focus on student learning and teacher growth.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty who want to implement AI tools in their courses in ways that are genuinely human-centered and continuously improving must develop practices for reflecting on their AI use, gathering student feedback, and adjusting their approaches based on evidence of impact. Sustainable AI integration in higher education requires the same commitment to continuous improvement that defines excellent teaching.

T2.4: Designing AI-Inclusive Assessments & Academic Integrity

Teacher

As student access to generative AI expands, educators are redesigning assessments to ensure they measure genuine learning rather than AI-generated output. They need a balanced approach that includes AI-resistant, AI-assisted, and AI-partnered tasks — each designed to measure intended standards, provide equitable access, require transparent disclosure, and align with local academic-integrity expectations.

School/District Leader

Leaders who are responsible for maintaining academic integrity across their schools and districts must develop clear, consistent policies for AI use in student work that balance innovation with rigor. Without thoughtful guidance, both students and teachers are left to navigate these questions on their own, often in ways that undermine the integrity of the learning process.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers navigate a complex intersection when it comes to AI and academic integrity: some of their students use AI tools as assistive technology under their IEPs, while others are expected to demonstrate learning without AI support. They need practical frameworks for designing assessments that are both equitable for students with disabilities and rigorous enough to measure genuine learning in an age of generative AI.

Support Staff

Support staff members sometimes work with students on academic tasks and are in a position to observe and address inappropriate AI use. They want to understand the school's expectations around AI and academic integrity so they can reinforce consistent messages with students — but they also need to be sensitive to the fact that some students may be using AI tools as legitimate accommodations.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches support teachers in redesigning assessments to ensure they measure genuine learning in an age of generative AI. They need practical coaching frameworks for

helping teachers develop AI-inclusive assessment designs that are both rigorous and equitable — and for facilitating conversations about academic integrity that are nuanced, consistent, and grounded in what we know about how students learn.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty who want to ensure that their assessments remain meaningful and rigorous in an AI-accessible environment must rethink traditional assignment designs and develop new approaches to assessing genuine student learning. This requires both creative thinking about assessment design and clear, transparent communication with students about expectations for AI use.

L: AI for Learning

L1.1: Teaching Students How AI Works

Teacher

Educators are increasingly expected to help students understand how AI systems work, recognize their limitations, and engage with them critically — but many teachers lack deep technical expertise in this area. Teachers need practical, standards-aligned approaches that make AI concepts accessible to students at every grade level without requiring specialized computer science training.

School/District Leader

Leaders are increasingly expected to articulate a vision for AI literacy across their schools and districts, yet many have not established a coherent approach to teaching students how AI systems actually work. Without this foundation, student AI use tends to be uncritical and uninformed, creating risks for both learning and safety.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers are increasingly expected to help students with disabilities understand how AI systems generate outputs, why those outputs may be inaccurate, and where AI tools have limitations. They need accessible, developmentally appropriate approaches for teaching these concepts in ways that account for varied communication, cognitive, and learning needs without requiring specialized computer science expertise.

Support Staff

Support staff members often encounter students using AI tools during academic support, counseling, library, office, or other school interactions. They need a practical understanding of how AI systems generate responses, why those responses can be wrong or biased, and how to reinforce age-appropriate AI literacy messages without stepping beyond the boundaries of their roles.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches are being asked to help teachers introduce students to how AI systems work, but many educators are unsure how to translate technical concepts into age-appropriate instruction. Coaches need practical frameworks and instructional resources that help teachers explain AI capabilities, limitations, training data, and human verification across grade levels and content areas.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty across disciplines are encountering students who use AI tools fluently but without understanding how those tools generate outputs or why they sometimes fail. Teaching students how AI works — not just how to use it — is becoming an essential component of preparing graduates for a world shaped by these technologies.

L3.1: AI-Assisted Study Plans & Retrieval Practice

Teacher

Students balancing coursework, activities, work, and family responsibilities often struggle to develop consistent, effective study habits. They need practical, AI-supported study strategies that improve retention, fit real schedules, and build habits students can sustain independently — without requiring access to expensive tutoring or test-prep resources.

School/District Leader

Leaders who want to improve student academic performance across their schools and districts must address the reality that many students lack effective study strategies and self-regulated learning skills. AI tools offer new possibilities for supporting students in developing personalized study plans, but these tools must be implemented thoughtfully and equitably.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers many of their students struggle with executive function skills, including planning, time management, and study habits. They want to use AI to support the development of more effective study strategies for their students, but they need to ensure that AI-generated study plans are accessible, aligned with their students' IEP goals, and designed to build independence rather than dependency.

Support Staff

Support staff members often work with students who are struggling academically and who need help developing more effective study habits. They want to use AI to help students create personalized study plans and practice retrieval strategies, but they need practical, role-appropriate ways to facilitate these conversations without taking over the instructional work that belongs to teachers.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches are supporting teachers in helping students develop more effective study strategies, including the use of AI-assisted retrieval practice and spaced repetition. They need practical coaching frameworks for helping teachers integrate these approaches

into their instruction in ways that are evidence-based, accessible to all students, and sustainable over time.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty who want to support student success in their courses must address the reality that many students arrive without effective study strategies or the metacognitive skills needed to manage complex academic demands. AI tools can help students develop personalized study plans and practice retrieval, but faculty need strategies for integrating these tools in ways that build genuine learning skills.

L2.1: Critical Analysis: Evaluating AI Accuracy & Bias

Teacher

Students using AI research tools often encounter outputs that are incomplete, inaccurate, or that omit the perspectives of historically underrepresented communities. Students and teachers must develop the skills to evaluate AI-generated content critically, identify gaps and errors, find reliable sources, and make informed decisions about when and how to use AI for complex or culturally sensitive topics.

School/District Leader

Leaders who want to build a culture of critical thinking across their schools and districts must address the growing tendency for both students and staff to accept AI-generated information without adequate evaluation. Developing shared frameworks for assessing AI accuracy and bias is essential to responsible AI use at every level.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers want their students to develop critical thinking and information literacy skills, including the ability to evaluate AI-generated content. But many of their students have learning differences that affect how they process and evaluate information, and standard critical analysis frameworks may not be accessible to them without modification. They need strategies for teaching AI literacy in ways that are genuinely accessible and aligned with their students' learning needs.

Support Staff

Support staff members often help students navigate research tasks and evaluate information sources, but they have not had structured guidance on how to address AI-generated content in these conversations. They want to help students develop healthy skepticism about AI outputs, but they need practical, age-appropriate strategies they can use in their support interactions without overstepping their roles.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches are helping teachers integrate AI literacy into their instruction, including the critical analysis of AI-generated content. They need practical coaching frameworks for helping teachers design learning experiences that build students' ability to

evaluate AI outputs — without turning every lesson into a media literacy unit or creating additional planning burden for already-stretched teachers.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty across disciplines are grappling with students who submit AI-generated work without critically evaluating its accuracy, completeness, or potential bias. Teaching students to apply rigorous critical analysis to AI outputs is becoming a core academic skill, and faculty need practical strategies for building this capacity across their courses.

L2.2: Creative Production Beyond AI-Generated Content

Teacher

Educators want students to use AI as a creative partner without surrendering original thought, cultural voice, or personal perspective. Students need structured ways to initiate, direct, and evaluate AI-assisted creative work so that the final product reflects genuine student authorship rather than AI generation.

School/District Leader

Leaders who value student creativity and original thinking must grapple with the reality that AI tools can generate polished work quickly, potentially reducing students' motivation to develop their own creative voice. Building a school culture that values authentic creative production requires intentional leadership and clear expectations.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers want their students to use AI as a creative tool while still developing their own voice, perspective, and original thinking. But for many of their students, the creative process itself is a significant challenge — and AI tools that generate polished outputs quickly may undermine the struggle that leads to genuine learning. They need strategies for using AI to support creative production in ways that build rather than bypass their students' creative capacities.

Support Staff

Support staff members sometimes help students with creative projects and assignments, and they have noticed that some students are submitting AI-generated work as their own. They want to help students understand the difference between using AI as a creative partner and using it as a shortcut — but they need practical language and strategies for having these conversations in ways that are supportive rather than punitive.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches are helping teachers design creative learning experiences that leverage AI as a tool while preserving the authentic creative work that develops student voice and original thinking. They need coaching strategies for helping teachers structure creative projects so that AI use is intentional, transparent, and genuinely in service of student learning rather than a substitute for it.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty in creative and humanities disciplines are facing a fundamental challenge: AI tools can produce competent writing, art, and other creative work, raising questions about what it means to develop an original creative voice in an AI-accessible environment. Faculty need strategies for designing creative assignments that genuinely require and develop human creativity.

L1.2: Personalized Learning Pathways with AI

Teacher

Teachers serve students with varied interests, readiness levels, connectivity, and access to advanced coursework. They need equitable, privacy-respecting ways to use AI for pacing, pathway options, and resource matching without creating a two-tiered experience or relying on opaque predictions about student potential.

School/District Leader

Leaders who want to support personalized learning at scale face the challenge of helping teachers use AI tools in ways that genuinely respond to individual student needs rather than simply automating one-size-fits-all instruction. Without clear guidance and shared frameworks, personalized learning initiatives often fail to deliver on their promise.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers are responsible for designing instruction that meets the diverse needs of students with disabilities, including students who are significantly below grade level, students with complex communication needs, and students who require substantial modifications to the general curriculum. They want to use AI to support differentiation and scaffolding, but they need to ensure that AI-generated materials are genuinely accessible and aligned with their students' IEP goals.

Support Staff

Support staff members often work directly with students who are struggling — providing one-on-one support, re-explaining concepts, and helping students access materials that were not originally designed for them. They want to use AI to help them find or create more accessible versions of materials quickly, but they need to know how to evaluate whether AI-generated adaptations are actually meeting their students' needs.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches are helping teachers design more differentiated instruction, and AI tools offer new possibilities for generating scaffolded materials and varied learning experiences. They need practical coaching moves for helping teachers use AI to differentiate more efficiently — while ensuring that differentiation decisions are still driven by teacher knowledge of their students, not just AI-generated defaults.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty teaching large or diverse courses face significant challenges in personalizing the learning experience for each student. AI tools offer new possibilities for adaptive pathways

and individualized feedback, but faculty need practical strategies for integrating these tools without compromising the depth and rigor of their courses.

L3.2: Reflection, Metacognition & Learning Journals

Teacher

Schools that use reflection and learning journals to strengthen student agency often find that entries are surface-level or compliance-driven. Teachers need AI-supported prompts and routines that deepen metacognitive thinking without making reflection feel like another assignment or exposing sensitive student disclosures to AI tools.

School/District Leader

Leaders who want to build a culture of continuous improvement across their schools and districts must find ways to make reflection a genuine and productive practice for both students and staff. AI tools offer new possibilities for supporting structured reflection, but building authentic reflective practice requires more than technology — it requires cultural change.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers reflection and metacognition are especially important for their students — many of whom have not yet developed strong self-awareness about their own learning processes. They want to use AI to support more structured reflection practices, but they need to ensure that AI-generated prompts are accessible to students with diverse communication needs and that reflection activities are building genuine self-knowledge rather than surface-level compliance.

Support Staff

Support staff members often have brief, informal interactions with students that could be powerful opportunities for reflection — but they do not always have the tools or language to facilitate meaningful metacognitive conversations. They want to use AI to help them develop better reflection prompts and routines for their interactions with students, in ways that are appropriate to their roles and genuinely useful to students.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches are helping teachers build reflection and metacognition into their instructional routines. They need practical coaching strategies for helping teachers use AI to generate more thoughtful reflection prompts, analyze patterns in student reflection data, and create classroom cultures where metacognition is a valued and visible part of learning.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty who want students to develop stronger metacognitive skills and engage in deeper reflection about their learning face the challenge of making reflection feel meaningful rather than performative. AI tools can support structured reflection and help students identify patterns in their thinking, but faculty need strategies for designing reflective practices that genuinely build metacognitive capacity.

L1.3: Accessibility, Goal-Setting & Equitable Access

Teacher

Schools strengthening personalized and competency-based learning must ensure that AI-supported tools for goal-setting and progress monitoring expand access for all students — including those with disabilities, English learners, and students in under-resourced settings — without replacing human relationships or making high-stakes decisions automatically.

School/District Leader

Leaders are responsible for ensuring that AI tools are implemented equitably across their schools and districts, with particular attention to students who have historically had less access to high-quality resources and support. Without intentional planning, AI adoption can widen rather than close existing opportunity gaps.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers work with students who have legally mandated goals for academic progress, and they are responsible for tracking and documenting their growth toward these goals. They want to use AI to support goal-setting and progress monitoring, but they must ensure that any AI tools used in this work are aligned with IEP requirements, accessible to students with disabilities, and used in ways that preserve student agency and dignity.

Support Staff

Support staff members often help students set goals and reflect on their progress, but they do not always have access to the data or tools that would help them do this effectively. They want to use AI to support more structured goal-setting conversations with students, but they need to understand how to do this in ways that are appropriate to their roles and that genuinely empower students rather than creating new forms of compliance.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches are supporting teachers in helping students set meaningful academic goals and track their own progress. They need practical coaching strategies for helping teachers use AI to make goal-setting more personalized and evidence-based — while ensuring that students remain active agents in their own learning rather than passive recipients of AI-generated targets.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty who want to use AI to support student goal-setting and academic planning must ensure that these tools are accessible to all students, including those with disabilities, those from under-resourced backgrounds, and those who are less familiar with AI platforms. Equitable access to AI-enhanced learning requires deliberate design choices.

L3.3: Mastery Tracking, Goal-Setting & Academic Rigor

Teacher

Districts expanding personalized and competency-based learning need manageable ways for students to track evidence of mastery, set rigorous goals, and revise their learning plans. Any AI support must align with content standards, avoid opaque predictions, and leave final judgments with students and educators.

School/District Leader

Leaders who want to implement competency-based approaches to learning and assessment across their schools and districts face the challenge of tracking individual student mastery at scale. AI tools offer new possibilities for monitoring progress and supporting goal-setting, but these systems must be implemented in ways that are equitable and aligned with clear learning standards.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers are responsible for tracking student progress toward IEP goals and helping students develop a meaningful understanding of their own growth. They want to use AI to support more systematic mastery tracking and goal-setting, but they must ensure that these systems are accessible to students with disabilities, aligned with IEP requirements, and used in ways that build student agency rather than reducing learning to a compliance exercise.

Support Staff

Support staff members sometimes help students track their progress and set goals, but they do not always have access to the data or systems that would make this work meaningful. They want to use AI to support more structured goal-setting and mastery tracking in their interactions with students, but they need practical, role-appropriate strategies that complement rather than duplicate the work of classroom teachers.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches are supporting teachers in helping students develop a clear, evidence-based understanding of their own mastery and growth. They need practical coaching frameworks for helping teachers use AI to make mastery tracking more manageable, more meaningful to students, and more connected to the instructional decisions that teachers make every day.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty who want to implement competency-based or mastery-oriented approaches to assessment face the challenge of tracking individual student progress across complex learning outcomes. AI tools can support more granular mastery tracking and facilitate meaningful academic advising, but faculty need practical strategies for integrating these tools without creating additional administrative burden.

D: AI for Systems

D1.1: AI-Assisted Needs Assessment

Teacher

School and district improvement teams are increasingly expected to synthesize multiple data sources — assessment results, attendance, course performance, and student-group data — to identify where students need support. The volume and complexity of this data can make pattern recognition slow and inconsistent. Teams need efficient, privacy-conscious ways to surface meaningful patterns and generate hypotheses without allowing AI to substitute for professional interpretation.

School/District Leader

Leaders who want to use AI to support comprehensive needs assessment across their schools and districts must develop a clear-eyed view of both the potential and the limitations of AI-assisted data analysis. Without strong human oversight and a clear understanding of what the data can and cannot tell them, AI-assisted needs assessment can produce misleading conclusions that drive poor decisions.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers must synthesize assessment results, progress-monitoring data, classroom performance, behavioral information, and family input to identify student needs and plan appropriate supports. AI can help organize information and surface possible patterns, but educators need privacy-conscious processes that prevent incomplete data or automated conclusions from replacing individualized analysis and professional judgment.

Support Staff

Support staff members often hold valuable information about student attendance, behavior, engagement, family circumstances, and day-to-day functioning that may inform a school needs assessment. They need role-appropriate ways to use AI to organize observations and identify possible patterns while protecting sensitive information and ensuring that trained educators interpret the findings.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches often facilitate teams as they examine assessment results, student work, intervention data, and instructional practices to identify priority needs. They need practical methods for using AI to synthesize multiple data sources and generate questions or hypotheses while ensuring that local context, educator expertise, and collaborative interpretation drive the final conclusions.

Higher Ed Faculty

Institutional researchers and academic leaders who want to use AI to support program evaluation and needs assessment must navigate important questions about data quality, analytical validity, and the appropriate interpretation of AI-generated insights. Using AI

effectively for institutional needs assessment requires both technical skill and strong judgment about the limits of data-driven conclusions.

D2.1: AI Policy Development & Governance

Teacher

Districts are seeing rapid, uneven adoption of generative AI by students and staff. Leaders need a locally workable governance framework aligned with applicable privacy law, district expectations, and academic-integrity priorities — without blocking responsible use or creating compliance burdens that outpace capacity.

School/District Leader

Leaders who are responsible for developing AI policies for their schools and districts must navigate complex questions about appropriate use, equity, privacy, and academic integrity. Without clear, well-developed policies, staff and students are left to navigate these questions on their own, often in ways that create inconsistency and risk.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers need AI policies that address the legal and instructional realities of serving students with disabilities, including privacy, IDEA requirements, assistive technology, accommodations, and individualized decision-making. Without explicit guidance, staff may apply general AI rules in ways that unintentionally restrict access, expose protected information, or conflict with students' educational plans.

Support Staff

Support staff members use and encounter AI across communications, records, scheduling, student services, and direct support, yet district policies do not always explain what is permitted in these varied contexts. They need clear, role-specific governance that defines approved tools, protected information, human-review expectations, and procedures for raising questions or concerns.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches are often responsible for helping teachers translate district AI policy into consistent classroom practice. They need governance frameworks that clarify acceptable use, privacy, academic integrity, tool approval, and instructional flexibility so they can support implementation without creating conflicting expectations across teachers, grade levels, or schools.

Higher Ed Faculty

Institutional leaders who are responsible for developing AI policies for their campuses must navigate complex questions about academic integrity, faculty autonomy, student privacy, and the appropriate role of AI in teaching and learning. Developing effective AI governance frameworks requires both technical understanding and broad stakeholder engagement.

D1.2: Real-Time Data Dashboards & Monitoring

Teacher

Schools need practical ways to monitor student progress in academics, attendance, behavior, and intervention response between formal assessment windows. Staff want timely signals that help them identify students who need support, but any monitoring system must use locally approved data, protect student privacy, and keep educators — not algorithms — in the decision-making role.

School/District Leader

Leaders who want to use real-time data dashboards to monitor school and district performance must develop the capacity to interpret data accurately, identify meaningful patterns, and make timely instructional and operational decisions. Without strong data literacy and clear protocols for acting on dashboard data, these tools can create information overload rather than actionable insight.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers monitor progress toward IEP goals, intervention response, attendance, behavior, and access to instruction across multiple systems. Real-time dashboards can make emerging needs more visible, but educators need tools and protocols that present accessible, accurate information without reducing individual students to data points or allowing automated signals to replace professional interpretation.

Support Staff

Support staff members may enter, review, or act on timely information related to attendance, behavior, counseling, health, interventions, or family contacts. They need clear guidance for interpreting dashboard signals within the boundaries of their roles, documenting information accurately, protecting confidentiality, and escalating concerns to the appropriate educators rather than relying on automated alerts alone.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches help teachers and collaborative teams turn dashboard information into timely instructional responses. They need practical frameworks for identifying meaningful trends, connecting real-time data to classroom evidence, and facilitating action without overwhelming teachers with information or treating AI-generated alerts as definitive conclusions about students.

Higher Ed Faculty

Institutional leaders and program directors who use data dashboards to monitor student success and program effectiveness must develop the capacity to interpret complex data accurately and make timely, evidence-based decisions. Using AI to enhance data monitoring requires both technical skill and strong judgment about the appropriate use of data in educational decision-making.

D2.2: Stakeholder Communication & Engagement

Teacher

Districts introducing new AI expectations face a wide range of views among teachers, families, students, and community members — from enthusiasm to deep concern. Leaders need communication strategies that build shared understanding, surface legitimate questions, and maintain trust without overpromising or dismissing concerns.

School/District Leader

Leaders who want to use AI to enhance stakeholder communication and engagement must develop approaches that maintain the authentic, relational quality of effective communication while leveraging AI to improve efficiency and reach. Without careful attention to voice and authenticity, AI-assisted communications can feel impersonal and undermine the trust that effective leadership communication requires.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers manage a high volume of communication with families, general education teachers, administrators, and related service providers. Much of this communication is time-sensitive and legally significant. They want to use AI to draft and manage these communications more efficiently, but they need to ensure that AI-generated content is accurate, appropriately personalized, and compliant with FERPA and IDEA requirements.

Support Staff

Support staff members are often the first point of contact for families, students, and community members — answering phones, responding to emails, and communicating about sensitive topics. They want to use AI to help draft responses and manage communication more efficiently, but they are not sure how to maintain the warm, personal tone that defines effective support work when using AI-generated text.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches communicate regularly with teachers, administrators, and families in ways that require nuance, trust, and professional judgment. They want to use AI to manage the volume of their communication demands without losing the relational quality that makes coaching effective. They need practical strategies for using AI as a drafting partner while keeping their authentic voice at the center.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty and academic leaders who use AI to support stakeholder communication must develop practices that maintain the intellectual and relational quality of their communications while leveraging AI to manage the volume and complexity of their communication demands. Using AI effectively for academic communication requires both technical skill and strong professional judgment.

D2.3: Professional Growth, Culture & Capacity-Building

Teacher

School systems managing multiple simultaneous changes — instructional priorities, student-support redesigns, and AI integration — need professional learning structures that build genuine AI capacity without adding unsustainable demands, and that connect new skills to the work educators are already doing.

School/District Leader

Leaders who are responsible for professional growth and capacity-building across their schools and districts can use AI tools to support more personalized, responsive professional development. Building a culture of continuous professional growth requires both effective use of AI tools and a deep commitment to the human relationships and shared values that sustain professional learning communities.

Special Education

The professional growth needs of special education teachers and case managers are specific: they need to stay current on IDEA requirements, evidence-based practices for students with disabilities, and the rapidly changing landscape of AI tools that may affect their students. They want to use AI to support their own professional learning, but they also need to ensure that the resources and strategies they encounter are grounded in the realities of special education practice.

Support Staff

Professional development opportunities for support staff members are often designed for classroom teachers and do not address the specific knowledge and skills they need in their roles. They want to use AI to identify professional learning resources that are relevant to their work, build their skills, and contribute more effectively to their school's improvement efforts.

Instructional Coach

The professional growth of instructional coaches is inseparable from their ability to support teacher growth. They want to use AI to design more personalized coaching plans, identify high-quality professional development resources, and track teacher progress over time. But they also need to ensure that their use of AI in coaching is transparent, ethical, and grounded in evidence of what works.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty developers and academic leaders who are responsible for supporting faculty professional growth can use AI tools to help design more personalized and responsive professional development experiences. Using AI effectively for faculty development requires both technical skill and a deep understanding of the professional culture and values of higher education.

D1.3: Strengthening Collaborative Team Structures with AI

Teacher

Collaborative teams vary widely in size, experience, and access to specialists. Leaders and instructional coaches need a consistent process for examining student work, aligning responses to grade-level standards, and documenting next steps without allowing AI summaries to replace the professional dialogue that makes collaborative teams effective.

School/District Leader

Leaders who want to use AI to strengthen collaborative team structures across their schools and districts must help teams develop the capacity to use AI tools in ways that enhance rather than replace the genuine professional dialogue and shared accountability that define effective collaboration. Without intentional attention to team culture and process, AI adoption can create the appearance of collaboration without the substance.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers participate in IEP teams, grade-level teams, intervention teams, and other collaborative structures that must coordinate supports around individual students. AI can help teams prepare, synthesize information, and document next steps, but its use must protect student privacy and preserve the individualized discussion, shared accountability, and family voice central to effective collaboration.

Support Staff

Support staff members contribute important observations to student-support teams, but their perspectives may be difficult to capture consistently across meetings and documentation systems. They need role-appropriate ways to use AI to organize observations, prepare for team discussions, and document agreed-upon actions while ensuring that communication remains accurate and that decisions stay with the responsible professionals.

Instructional Coach

Instructional coaches facilitate collaborative teams that vary in experience, focus, and effectiveness. They need structured protocols for using AI to prepare agendas, synthesize evidence, identify discussion questions, and document next steps while ensuring that AI supports—not substitutes for—the professional dialogue, collective responsibility, and instructional decision-making that strong teams require.

Higher Ed Faculty

Faculty and academic leaders who want to use AI to support departmental and program-level collaboration must navigate important questions about how AI tools can enhance shared planning, data analysis, and decision-making without undermining the professional autonomy and intellectual engagement that define academic collaboration.

D1.4: School Improvement Planning with AI

Teacher

School improvement teams must translate needs assessment findings into focused plans aligned with state and district expectations. Teams need to connect assessment evidence, stakeholder voice, adult actions, student outcomes, resource decisions, and progress-monitoring routines while avoiding AI-generated plans that lack local context or accountability.

School/District Leader

Leaders who are responsible for school improvement planning must develop approaches that use AI tools to enhance the quality and responsiveness of their plans without reducing the complex, collaborative process of improvement to a data-driven exercise. Effective school improvement requires both rigorous analysis and deep human judgment about what matters most for students and communities.

Special Education

Special education teachers and case managers are often asked to contribute to school improvement planning, but their perspective — and the needs of their students — are not always reflected in the final plan. They want to use AI to help analyze special education data and develop targeted improvement strategies, but they need to ensure that improvement efforts are grounded in a genuine understanding of individual student needs and that the voices of students with disabilities and their families are part of the process.

Support Staff

Support staff members have a unique vantage point on school improvement: they see students and families in ways that classroom teachers and administrators often do not. They want to contribute meaningfully to school improvement planning, but they are not always invited into these conversations or given the tools to analyze data from their own work. They want to use AI to help surface insights from their daily interactions with students and communicate them effectively to the teams that are making improvement decisions.

Instructional Coach

School improvement planning is central to the work of instructional coaches — but the planning process can be time-consuming and disconnected from the day-to-day realities of teaching and learning. They need practical frameworks for using AI to help analyze school data, develop professional development plans, and monitor implementation progress — while ensuring that the improvement process remains collaborative, evidence-based, and genuinely focused on the students and teachers they serve.

Higher Ed Faculty

Academic leaders who are responsible for program improvement planning can use AI tools to help analyze program data, identify improvement priorities, and develop action plans. Using AI effectively for program improvement requires both technical skill and a clear

understanding of the institutional context and values that should guide improvement efforts.